

of damage to your computer, which could cost you dear. The damage could consist of important files destroyed, corrupted data, slowing down of the infected computer, interrupted or unexpected closing of important programs, or it could be any or all of these; and chances are you won't realise that your computer is hit by a virus until it's much too late.

Viruses have grown in number and evolved in nature over the past decade. Before that, it was quite all right to have a basic and even outdated anti-virus program on your computer, which would scan floppies or CDs. That simple task would qualify as protection at the time, but we now need active anti-virus programs, constantly running, checking every file you download or execute.